CHAPTER

1

INTRODUCTION TO CLOTHING

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LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- To understand the origin of clothing.
- To gain knowledge about ancient clothing and the need for clothing.
- To learn the theories of clothing.

1.1 INTRODUCTION

In this modern era clothing is as important as food. Clothing is an indicator for one's good health and behavior. Clothing lays the foundation for one's personality development and standard of life, as the saying goes clothes make up the man.

1.2 ORIGIN OF SEWING AND FABRIC

The beginning of sewing and fabric dates back to the Stone Age man. The Stone Age man used animal skin as clothes to protect them from animals and climatic changes. Early man also used grasses, reeds, leaves, barks and stem to cover his body. When man learnt to live in one place (near the river beds) and to cultivate crops for food, he also slowly mastered the art of fabric making. The major fibres used were cotton, silk, linen and wool. During the 18th century man started spinning (twisting of fibre) and hand weaving (interlacing of yarn) to produce fabrics. Only during the 20th century men started to manufacture artificial yarns and are called as man-made yarns.

Primarily, clothing was a kind of drape in earlier years. Clothes were also decorated with colour, prints and embroideries. Today clothes are designed in computers. Digital clothes to monitor one's health are also available in the market.

1.3 PURPOSES / NEED FOR CLOTHING

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Clothing is a basic cover for human body. Clothing varies based upon sex, climatic conditions, standard of living, occupation, religion, nationality and personal liking.

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